



10-24-2023 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3gB1DU56kQo
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Municipal Meeting Report: Muncie Community Schools Board of Education

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officers called the regular meeting of the Muncie Community Schools Board of Education to order [00:04:51](#), preceded by a moment of silence and the Pledge of Allegiance [00:05:11](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - *Present:* Mr. Heeter, [First name not stated] Griffin, Mr. Irvin, and Mr. Low.
 - *Absent:* Mr. Williams.
 - *Presiding Officer:* Identified collectively through board leadership.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Included a moment of silence and the Pledge of Allegiance [00:04:51<U+2013>00:05:20].
- **Approval of Minutes:** Prior meeting minutes and procedural items were handled via routine board motion.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **01:10:30 Employee Medical Insurance Quotes and Carrier for 2024**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chief Financial Officer Brad Donahoe / Human Resources / Brown and Brown Consultants.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed quotes from three marketplace carriers provided by insurance consultants Brown and Black (Richard Su and Nick Neer). The district recommended transitioning medical, dental, and vision coverage to Anthem, utilizing a self-funded model. The transition results in a 4% decrease in employee medical insurance premiums for 2024. Additionally, the district will provide an increased HRA/HSA contribution (\$1,000 for single plans, \$2,000 for single-plus-one or family plans). The previous carrier will return a self-funded reserve balance of over \$2.5 million to the district's books.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **01:22:35 Additional Appropriation Advertisement (Rainy Day and Education Funds)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** CFO Brad Donahoe.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board considered authorization to advertise a public hearing for additional appropriations in 2023: \$2.7 million for the Rainy Day Fund (to cover capital repairs and fourth-quarter operational items) and \$1.7 million for the Education Fund (to cover increased payroll and headcount expenses resulting from higher enrollment). CFO Donahoe confirmed these funds will be drawn from existing cash balances and will not increase property tax rates in 2023 or 2024. The public hearing will be held at the November 14 board meeting.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **01:24:42 Altria Vaping Settlement Participation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Board authorization requested to join the nationwide Altria vaping settlement, following previous participation in the Juul settlement.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **01:25:12 Policy Updates**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Routine housekeeping updates involving combining and renaming policies under Church and Amen's numbering system, and retiring policies rendered obsolete due to House Enrollment Act 1315.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:00:10 Mr. Richard Skinner** (Taxpayers News / Local Resident)
 - Addressed the published notices regarding upcoming additional appropriations out of the rainy day and education funds (\$2.7M and operational/maintenance figures).

Commended the district for maintaining healthy cash balances without raising tax levies (driven by property value increases). Requested more public clarification regarding the reported arrangement granting the YMCA access to the school Fieldhouse facilities.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Southside Middle School Presentation 00:06:00:** Administrators presented updates on school culture, grade-level “teaming” models, attendance improvements (reaching 88%), a 20% drop in discipline referrals, and ongoing behavioral and academic interventions.
 - **Human Resources / Recruitment 00:39:07:** Dr. Bell presented an update on transitioning applicant tracking and onboarding to the state-backed “Nimble” platform, partnering with Indiana universities and expanding the teacher recruitment pool.
 - **Superintendent Updates 00:51:03:** Dr. Kowski reported K-12 enrollment is up 90 students (totaling 4,951, the highest since 2018); new playground installations at Ewa and Longfellow; upcoming Walnut Street construction closures affecting Muncie Central; a new student Writing Center partnership with Ball State University; upcoming voting site logistics for the November election; and various community events including a Trunk-or-Treat, Holiday Art Show, and Veterans Day programs.
 - **Financial & Bond Updates 01:02:46:** CFO Donahoe reported September ADM numbers, a \$6.1 million bond sale on October 16 for the Muncie Central stadium athletic facilities/concession project (bids came in under budget with work slated through August 2024), and a significant five-level upgrade in the district’s bond rating to BBB+.
- **Adjournment:** Official motion to adjourn carried by voice vote **01:30:29**.